



A-NPDC

ACCOMACK-NORTHAMPTON PLANNING DISTRICT COMMISSION

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September 15, 2025

To the UVA's Environmental Institute Climate Collaborative Program Manager:

On behalf of the Accomack-Northampton Planning District Commission (A-NPDC), I am pleased to express our support for the proposal led by Dr. Majid Shafiee-Jood at the University of Virginia to develop community-driven, climate-resilient wastewater solutions in coastal rural regions. This initiative directly aligns with our mission to promote sound regional planning and improve the quality of life for residents on the Eastern Shore of Virginia.

We are especially encouraged by the project's focus on failing septic systems and decentralized wastewater infrastructure, an issue of increasing urgency in our region. In recent years, A-NPDC has actively worked to support septic system upgrades for low-to-moderate income households, including through a grant from the Virginia Department of Environmental Quality that provided free pump-outs and, in some cases, system replacements. We see this research initiative as an opportunity to build on and extend those efforts through data-informed planning, decision-support tools, and expanded partnerships.

We appreciate UVA's commitment to community-engaged research and its collaborative approach to addressing one of our region's most pressing infrastructure challenges. We look forward to staying involved and informed as the project moves forward.

Sincerely,

A handwritten signature in blue ink, appearing to read "Elaine K.N. Meil".

Elaine K.N. Meil
Executive Director